Cedar Valley Family Center AI use policy

Draft for board review · Effective when the board approves it · Owner: Luis, operations manager · Next review: In 12 months

Why we have this policy. We want AI to lift paperwork off your plate. We want to protect families' privacy and stop errors going out under our name.

Who it covers. Staff, volunteers, contractors and board members, including on personal accounts used for our work.

TOOLS WE USE

- **Microsoft Copilot (pilot):** Drafting appeals, thank-yous and grant summaries. No protected information.
- **ChatGPT (free or personal accounts):** Lesson plans, reading passages, practice questions, translations. No protected information.
- **Canva AI images:** Images for communications. No protected information.
- **New tools, add-ons and AI features.** Luis approves any new tool, plugin, AI agent or AI feature in current software, checking where data goes and what our contracts allow. Client data also needs Grace.

WHAT YOU CAN USE AI FOR

- Draft appeals and thank-you letters
- Summarize grant guidelines
- Make lesson plans and reading passages at different levels
- Write GED practice questions
- Translate handouts into Spanish

NEEDS APPROVAL FIRST

- New tool, plugin or AI feature, including email readers — *Luis*
- Any use touching client data — *Luis and Grace (compliance director)*
- AI help with county or grant reports — *Your manager*

OFF LIMITS

- **Never put this into an AI tool** unless the tool is approved for it above: Case files (names, addresses, income, immigration status, children, domestic violence, mental health and substance use notes); donor names, giving history, gift notes; student names, scores, grades, attendance; staff HR files; volunteer details. Our county contract and district agreement require this.
- No AI photos passed off as real families.
- People, not AI, write public statements about the news.

CHECK EVERYTHING BEFORE IT GOES OUT

- A person reads all AI output first, checking facts, names, numbers, tone and bias.
- Check county and grant report numbers against our records. Whoever sends it owns it.

DECISIONS ABOUT PEOPLE

- AI never decides emergency fund awards. Caseworkers and supervisors do.
- AI never scores intake essays or places students in class levels.

BEING OPEN ABOUT AI

- A thank-you a person signed needs no AI note.
- We label AI-made images and teaching materials.
- We answer funders honestly about AI, including grant writing.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Tell Luis and Grace the same day. For client data, Grace decides if it is a breach under the county contract.
- Reporting a mistake is expected, not punished.

WHO OWNS THIS POLICY

- Luis owns this policy. The board approves it and any changes.
- Everyone gets an hour of training, not just an email.
- We review it in 12 months.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE BOARD

- Do we buy ChatGPT Team, extend Copilot to everyone, or neither?
- May AI ever help with case notes, once the county's rules are known?
- Should we promise AI won't be used to cut positions?
- Is Luis the right policy owner?

Sample policy for an invented organization, drafted by Fulton Ring from a mock 30-minute call. Not legal advice; not reviewed by a real nonprofit.